

**Topic 4:
Biodiversity and
natural resources**

This topic begins with a comparison of the structure of a typical plant cell with that of an animal cell, and the structure and roles of cellulose and starch. The relationship between plant tissues, xylem and sclerenchyma, is also included. The topic continues with a consideration of the importance of plant products to humans, species diversity, and how diversity arises through natural selection and evolutionary change. The role of zoos in the conservation of endangered species is also described.

2.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper, which carries 80 marks, lasts 1 hour 15 minutes and will include:

- objective questions
- structured questions
- short-answer questions

and will also cover:

- *How Science Works*
- practical-related questions.

The unit is the same size as Unit 1, to allow for time to develop practical skills for Unit 3 assessment.